4.10 REST AND SLEEP.

4.10.1 Introduction

Getting adequate rest and sleep is an important component of overall health and quality of life. Sleep is one thing that is universal to people.It is vital for optimal psychological and physiological functioning. Sleep is essential to conserve energy, prevent fatigue, and to restore the mind and the body.Sleep is an often overlooked essential for optimal health and well-being.

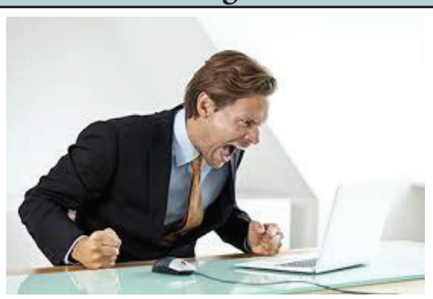
Difference between rest and sleep:

Circadian Rhythm and Sleep.

Circadian rhythm is an ingrained biological clock that regulates the timing periods of tiredness and wakefulness throughout the day. The clock is calibrated by natural light in a 24-hour period. The functions of your circadian rhythm are based in the brain. (hypothalamus) It responsible for regulating many body functions that revolve around the 24-hour cycle including: body temperature, heart rate, blood pressure, and the release of hormones such as melatonin which helps us with sleep.



Rest	Sleep
When we give our body a period for relaxation, we relate our muscles, and sometimes close our eyes for comfort. But, our brain is running its functions actively during resting phase too. We have our full consciousness about the surrounding during resting time.	In this condition our brain does not work actively. We do not have our full consciousness about the surroundings. Our brain takes rest as well as our body muscles do.
Amount of Sleep Needed. Each individual's sleep needs vary. In general, most healthy adults need an average of ***eight hours of sleep*** at night. **Normal sleep : 8 hours** ***Adequate sleep provides only positive, healthful benefits.***	

Lack of Sleep	Images
Irritability and moodiness are some of the first signs a person experiences from lack of sleep.	

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